

1.7 Unit 1, Option E: The Expansion and Challenge of Nationalism

Focus

This option concentrates on the themes of nationalism and conflict in Europe and the Middle East from the beginning of the 19th century, with particular emphasis on both how and why ideas about nationhood emerged and developed in particular states and how, in some cases, nationalist ideas provided the stimulus for the development of authoritarian, totalitarian or fascist regimes. Whichever combinations are chosen, this option enables students to understand the importance of the ideas and beliefs associated with nationalism and why nationalism and national identities are frequently contentious or problematic concepts.

Clarification of content for each topic can be found in *Appendix 1*.

Students entered for Option E are required to study TWO of the topics from E1-E6. There are six topics in Unit 1, Option E.

E1 The Road to Unification: Italy, c1815-70

- Opposition to autocratic and foreign rule in Piedmont, Tuscany and Venice; the Carbonari in Naples; republicanism and Young Italy — the influence of Mazzini to 1848; the legacy of the 1848 revolutions.
- The roles of Cavour, Victor Emmanuel and Garibaldi; the role of the Church.
- The importance of foreign intervention and involvement in the 1850s and 1860s: France and Austria.

E2 The Unification of Germany, 1848-90

- The 1848 revolutions and their significance for unification.
- Economic features of pre-unification Germany and their implications for unification.
- Diplomacy, war and the significance of Bismarck to 1871.
- Developing national identity in a united Germany: Bismarck's relations with political parties; the kulturekampf and social policies under Bismarck.

E3 The Collapse of the Liberal State and the Triumph of Fascism in Italy, 1896-1943

- Weaknesses of the political system and attempts to stabilise it from 1903 under Giolitti; social discontent and political disorder, 1896-1912.
- The impact of the First World War on Italy and its impact on the Liberal state, 1918-23: Mussolini and the message and appeal of Fascism, 1919-22.
- Power and control in Fascist Italy: propaganda; terror; the PNF (Partito Nazionale Fascista); the relationship of the regime with the Church and the old elites.
- Building the new Roman Empire: Abyssinia, Spain and Italy's diplomatic and military preparations for war, 1933-41.

E4 Republicanism, Civil War and Francoism in Spain, 1931-75

- The abdication of Alfonso XIII and the establishment of a republic: reasons for this; Republican rule, 1931-6.
- Outbreak of Civil War: nature and extent of support for Republicans and Nationalists.
- The Civil War: course and outcome; impact of foreign intervention; reasons for Nationalism's success.
- The establishment of an authoritarian government and a corporatist state: key features of these; the Falange and the rule of Franco to 1975.

E5 Germany Divided and Reunited, 1945-91

- The partition of Germany: establishment and development of contrasting forms of government in East and West Germany.
- Contrasting economic development, living standards and achievements in East and West and the reasons for this.
- The roles of Adenauer, Erhard and Brandt in West Germany.
- The rule of Honecker in East Germany: his fall in 1989 and its implications; the collapse of communism and the reunification process to 1991.

E6 The Middle East, 1945-2001: The State of Israel and Arab Nationalism

- The situation in Palestine in 1945: the impact of Jewish guerrilla and terrorist groups; the end of the British mandate; UN plans for separate Arab and Israeli states; the foundation of an independent Israel in 1948.
- The significance of Arab reaction to the establishment of an independent Israel and to immigration into Israel to 1973: reasons for, and outcomes of, Arab-Israeli conflicts to 1973.
- The rise of nationalism in Egypt and Syria: the role of Nasser; establishment of a United Arab Republic and reasons for its failure; tensions within and between Arab states; secular modernisers versus militant Islam; Shia and Sunni Muslims; the growth of militant Islam in Iran; the significance of the Iranian Revolution in 1979.
- Arab nationalism in the 1980s and 1990s: reasons for, and outcomes of, the Iraq-Iran and Gulf Wars; reasons for, and significance of, the growth in Islamic fundamentalism.